

THE ASSOCIATE JOURNEY

Nine weeks from certified to job-ready.

9

WEEKS

Every MCCoE associate walks the same road — foundations, tools, the human layer, then proof under pressure. This is what an employer is hiring at the end of it.

PHASE 01 — GROUND

Build the vocabulary and the mental model

Weeks 1–3 · They learn to see the field and name what is on it

PHASE 02 — BUILD

Hands on the tools, and on the human layer

Weeks 4–6 · They learn to operate, not just to recognize

PHASE 03 — PROVE

Defend, respond, and prove it to an employer

Weeks 7–9 · They produce evidence a hiring manager can judge

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WEEK 1

Cybersecurity Foundations

- CIA Triad
- Threat, vulnerability, risk
- Core terminology
- Security principles

2

WEEK 2

Network Fundamentals

- TCP/IP and the OSI model
- Ports, protocols, packets
- Firewalls and segmentation

3

WEEK 3

Threat Landscape

- Threat actors and motives
- Malware families
- Attack vectors
- MITRE ATT&CK

4

WEEK 4

Core Classes

- Certification-aligned core domains
- Frameworks in depth
- Governance and controls

5

WEEK 5

Kali Linux Fundamentals

- Linux command line
- Recon and scanning
- The 5 phases of pentesting

6

WEEK 6

Human Factors

- Social engineering
- Phishing and pretexting
- Insider threat
- Professional communication

7

WEEK 7

Defensive Security & Tools

- Logging, monitoring, SIEM
- Detection and hardening
- NIST Cybersecurity Framework

8

WEEK 8

Incident Response Basics

- Cyber Kill Chain
- Triage and containment
- Executive summary writing

9

WEEK 9

Careers & Capstone

- Capstone analysis
- Résumé and interview
- Portfolio and briefing

WHAT THEY LEARN

WHAT THEY PRODUCE

CAPABILITY PROVEN

EMPLOYER READINESS

Terminology and CIA Triad assessment

Annotated network diagram and traffic walkthrough

Threat actor profile with ATT&CK technique IDs

Graded core coursework and framework assessments

Recon and scanning lab report from the attacker's view

Phishing analysis and an awareness brief for non-technical staff

Detection and hardening lab with mapped NIST functions

Executive summaries on 4 real breaches — Target, Colonial Pipeline, SolarWinds, Equifax

Capstone project, portfolio, and a presentation to a panel

Speaks the language of the field

Reads a network and explains what moved

Names the adversary and the technique

Applies frameworks to real organizations

Works the attacker's toolkit firsthand

Defends the human layer — and briefs it plainly

Detects, hardens, and monitors

Runs an incident and briefs an executive

Proves it to a hiring manager

Certified, but unproven

Operating with real tools

Job-ready